

LAWSHAOOR CHAMBERS

INTRODUCTION

LawShaoor Chambers is a full-service law firm based in Islamabad, with associated offices in other major cities of Pakistan. We are committed to providing clear, practical, and reliable legal services that meet the commercial needs of our clients. Our approach is to simplify complex legal issues and offer solutions that are both legally sound and commercially workable.

The Firm combines the experience of its partners with the skills of a dedicated team of associates to handle a wide range of civil, commercial, corporate, regulatory, and dispute resolution matters. We act for local and foreign companies, financial institutions, non-profit organizations, and individual clients. In every matter, we focus on professionalism, efficiency, and the best interests of the client.

LawShaoor Chambers has developed strength in sectors that are heavily regulated and commercially sensitive, including banking and finance, energy and natural resources, infrastructure, and corporate transactions. Our lawyers are familiar with the regulatory landscape in Pakistan and regularly appear before courts, tribunals, and regulatory authorities. Through this combination of advisory and contentious work, we aim to provide comprehensive legal support to clients operating in complex business environments.

LawShaoor Chambers works in strategic partnership with M.B. KEMP (ME) LLP, a law firm with offices in Hong Kong, London, Milan and Abu Dhabi. Through this collaboration, we are able to support clients on matters involving the UAE, DIFC, ADGM and other international jurisdictions. Our partnership with M.B. KEMP (ME) LLP strengthens our cross-border capability and allows us to draw on the experience of a global team recognized for its work in corporate, commercial, banking and finance, restructuring, international arbitration and complex dispute resolution.

PRACTICE AREAS

BANKING & FINANCE: The Firm regularly advises commercial banks, financial institutions, and non-banking finance companies (NBFCs) on a wide array of matters. Our expertise encompasses syndicated financing, Islamic modes of finance, debt restructuring, and the drafting and vetting of complex security documentation. We provide strategic counsel on regulatory compliance with State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) directives and represent financial institutions in high-value recovery suits and foreclosure proceedings before specialized Banking Courts and Tribunals.

CORPORATE & COMMERCIAL: The Lawyers of the Firm have experience in mainstream and specialized corporate and commercial matters that extend to a diverse range of matters such as incorporation of companies, dissolutions, corporate governance, mergers and acquisitions, Islamic modes of investment, licensing, corporate organization, exchange and repatriation controls, tax, and risk insurance and liaison with concerned regulatory bodies such as the Securities & Exchange Commission of Pakistan, the State Bank of Pakistan, the Federal Board of Revenue, the Competition Commission of Pakistan etc.

ENERGY AND NATURAL RESOURCES: LawShaoor Chambers has developed strong capabilities in the energy and petroleum sectors. Our Lawyers have advised clients across the upstream, midstream, and downstream chain, including matters involving OGRA, DGPC, and the Ministry of Energy. Our work includes assistance with licensing, concession agreements, joint operating agreements, LNG supply and storage arrangements, pipeline and terminal development, refinery documentation, EPC contracts, fuel supply arrangements, and environmental compliance. We also assist with cross-border energy transactions and regulatory matters affecting both local and international investors. Our lawyers also possess extensive experience of representing petroleum companies in high-stakes litigation matters.

CONSTRUCTION AND OPERATION: The team at LawShaoor Chambers have a proven ability of assisting in matters involving construction, maintenance, engineering and procurement issues etc. They have a proven track record of drafting, negotiating and advising on contracts based on FIDIC forms of contracts with contractors of international repute. In this respect, their practical experience in connection with export and import controls, licensing and understanding of regulatory compliance has provided additional value to the service provided to the Firm's Clients.

DISPUTE RESOLUTION AND ARBITRATION Dispute resolution is one of the Firm's core strengths. We represent clients before the High Courts, District Courts, specialized tribunals, regulatory bodies, and arbitration forums. Our experience includes commercial disputes, contractual claims, regulatory proceedings, competition matters, labor disputes, and arbitration under domestic and international rules. We handle all stages of dispute resolution, including pleadings, evidence, cross-examination, and final arguments.

MERGER AND ACQUISITION The Partner's involvement in some of the recent corporate acquisitions in Pakistan and UAE has established mergers and acquisitions as one of the Firm's most prominent strengths. The Firm's substantial experience in company, securities and competition law and its familiarity with the regulatory regime and relevant offices provide additional insight into the quality of advice rendered in proposing corporate mergers. In addition, the Firm's experience in proposing, undertaking and implementing Court approved compromises, arrangements and reconstructions provides an additional capability enabling sound and qualitative legal assistance. The Firm's involvement in these projects has included the following specific aspects of work: private limited company sales and purchases; asset purchases and sales; take-overs; vendor issues; legal due diligence and Court approved schemes of arrangement.

GOVERNMENT SECTOR The Firm's substantial experience in negotiation has proved particularly valuable in its interaction with the different departmental levels of the Government of Pakistan, providing additional facilitation and expedition in the procedural administration of applications, renewals, licensing and regulation. Based in the capital, its high-level co-operation with the Government, its Ministries and departmental entities has established a firm liaison with the concerned commercial bodies of the government. This access proves an invaluable asset to our clients. The Firm is also on the panel of advocates for various government departments.

TELECOMMUNICATION AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY The Firm has developed a broad capability with respect to the frontier aspects of the emerging fields of telecommunications and information technology. In this connection, lawyers of the Firm have extensively advised on telecommunication and information technology matters, including; provision of Internet-based services; setting-up of software houses; regulatory framework, satellite-based services, Internet-based services, voice over internet protocol (VOIP); telecommunication systems & services, infrastructure Long Distance International, fiber network; E-banking; data communications; encryption; import, installation, operation and maintenance of telecommunication equipment, and other ancillary matters such as cryptographic products and its legal status. The Firm has successfully developed a practical understanding of all legal and practical issues involved in these areas and provides additional

expertise to its routine advice and other areas of practice by way of its familiarity with the use and practice of state-of-the-art technology and its regulation and policy directives in Pakistan.

HEALTHCARE & PHARMACEUTICALS Our lawyers advise local and foreign clients on licensing, registration, and regulatory matters before the Drug Regulatory Authority of Pakistan. We assist with compliance, interpretation of applicable laws, and advisory work relating to the healthcare and pharmaceutical sectors.

LABOUR AND EMPLOYMENT Lawyers in the Firm regularly advise foreign as well as local clients on all labor/HR related issues in Pakistan including interpretation and application of labor legislation; advice and strategy with respect to CBA negotiations, employee benefits, compensation, employment contracts, termination, settlements, plant closings, lay-offs, employment contracts, employment insurance & protection and welfare, construction of labor management systems, drafting collective bargaining agreements including first contracts and renewals, in addition to acting as counsels and appearing before all labor forums including labor courts, labor appellate tribunals and High Courts of Pakistan.

NON-PROFIT Lawyers of the Firm have extensively advised both local and foreign philanthropists on a national, international and private level to devise logistically and financially sustainable strategies for its Clients. While routinely involved in advising and assisting with respect to private non-profit sector ventures including incorporations and establishment of trusts, societies and companies for objects as diverse as education, female empowerment, sustainable community development, child labor, tourism and infrastructure development, the Firm has been prominently involved in national initiatives on social sector reform and the representation of international and governmental aid agencies with respect to their administrative and project related activities in Pakistan. The lawyers' participation in social reform projects has involved advice and facilitation in all aspects of review and reform of the legislative, financial, administrative and co-coordinative reform of the concerned sectors while its representation of foreign donor agencies has entailed substantive advice and assistance with respect to project, labor, administrative, governmental, licensing, property, and other legal concerns arising in the context of their presence in Pakistan.

UAE & CROSS-BORDER PRACTICE In addition to our Pakistan-based practice, LawShaoor Chambers provides legal support on UAE-related matters through its partnership with M.B. KEMP (ME) LLP. Our combined team advises on corporate and commercial transactions, banking and finance, regulatory compliance, mergers and acquisitions, restructuring, DIFC and ADGM matters, and cross-border disputes. With experienced lawyers based in Abu Dhabi and Dubai, we are able to assist clients with both onshore and free-zone legal requirements, ensuring coordinated and efficient representation across jurisdictions.

TEAM

ABDUL MANAN

Founder, LawShaoor Chambers

Abdul Manan is an Islamabad-based corporate and commercial lawyer with over 13 years of experience specializing in the energy, technology, fintech, and banking sectors. He handles the full range of corporate and commercial matters, representing multinational corporations, financial institutions, high-growth tech enterprises, non-profit organizations and local & foreign companies. He regularly advise clients on everything from complex corporate structuring to the regulatory nuances of AI and financial technologies.

Before establishing LawShaoor Chambers, Mr. Manan worked with premier law firms across Pakistan and the Gulf region. He has a proven track record in executing major corporate restructurings, cross-border mergers and acquisitions, and corporate finance transactions.

Alongside his primary focus on corporate and technology law, Mr. Manan possesses extensive experience in the energy and petroleum sectors. Drawing on his tenure at RIAA Barker Gillette, CMS (Saudi Arabia), and M.B. Kemp, he advised major energy companies on the commercial structuring, regulatory compliance and project documentation relating to upstream and downstream operations. His work included drafting and negotiating agreements for oil and gas projects, advising on licensing and regulatory frameworks, and supporting clients on cross border energy transactions. This experience has given him a strong understanding of the legal and commercial dynamics of Pakistan's energy and petroleum industry.

Complementing his active practice, Mr. Manan is committed to the development of the legal profession. He serves as a visiting faculty member at several public sector universities in Islamabad, where he lectures on law.

SAHIBZADA SAAD

Off-Counsel

Sahibzada Saad is a courtroom advocate with over a decade of intensive litigation experience in civil and criminal litigation, white-collar defence, financial crimes, and regulatory matters. He routinely defends individuals and corporate entities facing severe exposure in fraud, embezzlement, breach of trust, and complex financial misconduct cases.

He provides incisive, defence-oriented counsel on contentious financial transactions, fund tracing, and regulatory compliance.

On the civil front, Mr. Saad regularly acts in hard-fought commercial and civil disputes. He is highly adept at securing urgent injunctive relief, navigating complex breach of contract claims, and managing protracted property and tortious disputes. His civil practice is defined by a highly strategic, trial-ready posture, ensuring clients are robustly represented from the issuance of pleadings through to final judgment and enforcement.

SIFATULLAH

Senior Associate

Mr. Sifat is a legal professional with a decade of experience in corporate, commercial, regulatory, and dispute resolution matters, advising clients across Pakistan and the UAE. He regularly advises businesses, corporate entities, and commercial clients on a wide range of transactional and regulatory matters.

Mr. Sifat has been involved in drafting and reviewing various corporate and commercial agreements including share purchase agreements, shareholders' agreements, term sheets, escrow arrangements, and other transactional documents for local and foreign clients.

In addition to his transactional practice, Mr. Sifat advises on corporate structuring, governance, regulatory compliance, and commercial advisory matters.

KOMAL IQBAL

Senior Associate

Ms. Komal is an Advocate of the High Courts of Pakistan with a specialized practice in data protection, GDPR compliance, and international regulatory frameworks. She has experience in civil litigation, corporate advisory, and international commercial law. She advises clients on privacy governance, cross-border data transfers, data processing agreements, internal compliance policies, and risk management relating to personal data.

She has worked with legal practices in Pakistan and the UAE, where she gained experience in DIFC and ADGM data protection regulations and broader international commercial law. Her practice includes advising on corporate compliance, dispute resolution, intellectual property matters, and regulatory obligations. She has represented clients before the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan, the Competition Commission of Pakistan, and other judicial and quasi-judicial forums.

Ms. Komal holds an LL.M. in International Commercial Law from the University of Aberdeen, Scotland, where her academic focus included data protection, digital regulation, and international commercial frameworks.

MALAK HUSSAIN ADEED

Associate

Mr. Hussain is an Islamabad-based advocate and a graduate of the University of London, currently practicing at LawShaoor Chambers. He is an Advocate of the High Courts and represents clients in a wide range of criminal and civil litigation matters. His practice focuses on criminal defence, white-collar offences, financial crimes, and complex multi-party disputes, where he regularly appears before trial courts, special tribunals, and the High Courts.

He has extensive experience handling criminal trials, including matters involving fraud, breach of trust, financial irregularities, regulatory offences, and other statutory violations. His courtroom advocacy and practical understanding of procedural law allow him to effectively represent individuals and businesses facing criminal proceedings.

MOHAMMAD KALIM WALI

Junior Associate

Mr. Kalim is an Associate at LawShaoor Chambers, with experience in litigation, corporate law, regulatory compliance, and legal research. He regularly handles civil, criminal, family, and corporate matters, providing legal services through research, drafting, case preparation, and court representation.

He regularly handles district court matters and drafts pleadings, legal notices, contracts, agreements, replies, and legal opinions across a range of practice areas. Mr. Kalim is also involved in corporate and regulatory compliance work, including SECP-related matters, maintenance of corporate records, and liaison with regulatory authorities to ensure compliance with legal and procedural requirements.

Mr. Kalim completed his LLB from NUST Law School. He previously worked with the Office of Legal Affairs at the University of Central Asia, Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, where he contributed to compliance initiatives, legal research, and institutional policy projects. His final year thesis focused on the legal and regulatory challenges faced by gig economy

workers in Pakistan and the need for stronger legal protections and policy reforms in the sector.